

Raffaele "Raf" Vitale

Staff Product Designer, Design Engineer

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Summary

Raf is a Staff-level Product Designer with 9 years of experience and deep experience across B2B platforms and workflows, marketplaces, crypto-native products and developer platforms. Raf designs systems, not screens, influencing product roadmaps and shaping technical feasibility as a hands-on practitioner with strategic reach.

Technical long before AI made hybrid roles obvious, Raf started in engineering and retained a builder's mindset. Raf prototypes in code, thinks in constraints, and uses rapid experimentation to validate direction before scale locks decisions in.

Raf designs for probabilistic behavior, trust boundaries, and evolving model capabilities rather than static interfaces. His work focuses on shaping AI-native interaction models, pressure-testing failure modes, and building trust through constraint, clarity, and explicit feedback loops.

Comfortable in high-ambiguity environments where patterns do not yet exist, Raf defines what should exist, sets the quality bar, and aligns product, research, and engineering around strong intent.

Experience

Walmart Global Tech, Walmart Seller / [walmart.com](#)

Staff Product Designer – AI Recommendation Systems, Marty AI | 2025 – Present

Sellers weren't adopting AI recommendations, not because the recommendations were wrong, but because they didn't understand the reasoning behind them. Trust wasn't a data problem; it was a design problem.

- Diagnosed that low adoption stemmed from a lack of visible reasoning, not feature gaps. Reframed the problem from "surface more recommendations" to "make the model's intent legible," shifting the product strategy and unblocking a stalled roadmap.
- Led UX for SuccessHub: consolidated five fragmented AI recommendation surfaces into a single decision-making experience. The core tension was between automation efficiency and seller agency, resolved by designing for *why-then-what* rather than action-first flows.

- Defined the trust architecture for Marty AI's seller-facing layer: established how model confidence, reasoning context, and actionability surface together, so sellers could act on AI insight without needing to understand the underlying model.
 - Prototyped Marty AI features for sellers, conducting hands-on work that informed and validated AI product direction.
 - Owned end-to-end design across mobile and web, partnering directly with data science to understand model outputs and translate statistical behavior into interaction patterns that held up under real-world variance.
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Obvious

Senior Product Designer – AI Systems | 2025

The hardest design problem in LLM-powered products isn't the interface: it's establishing trust in a system whose behavior is inherently probabilistic and always changing. Obvious needed interaction models that could handle that.

- Sole designer on the Skills framework: a system that let users extend AI behavior over time. The central trade-off was between model autonomy and user legibility: too much autonomy felt opaque; too much control created friction. Designed the handoff points that resolved this.
 - Designed early product versions and prototyped within research and early visuals, laying foundational work at the earliest stage.
 - Prototyped agent failure states and edge cases as primary decision tools, not for polish, but to pressure-test product direction with founders and engineering before committing to implementation. Prototypes replaced lengthy spec debates.
 - Established patterns for continuous learning interfaces: how users correct, refine, and build trust with a system that evolves. This wasn't a UI challenge; it was a systems design challenge where getting the feedback loop wrong would erode trust rather than build it.
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Theoriq

Founding Product Designer – AI & Crypto Agents | 2024 – 2025

AI agents operating with real financial assets in crypto environments demand a different design standard. Mistakes aren't undoable. The question wasn't *what* to show users; it was *how much* reasoning to expose before transparency becomes noise.

- Sole designer from zero. Defined the entire interaction paradigm for autonomous agents, balancing the tension between giving users enough visibility to trust the system and keeping cognitive load low enough that they'd actually use it.

- The key design decision: show decision points (where the agent chose between options) rather than execution steps. This built more trust in testing than full transparency did; users felt in control without needing to audit every action.
 - Translated experimental AI infrastructure into product vision for the CEO and founding team, making abstract agent behavior legible to non-technical stakeholders and establishing guardrails that preserved user agency without crippling system capability.
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Voiceflow

Senior Product Designer – AI Agents | 2025

Non-technical users were dropping off during onboarding not because agent-building was hard, but because their mental model of *what an agent is* was wrong before they started. A UI fix wouldn't solve it.

- Worked with executive leadership to reframe the onboarding problem: less about step-by-step guidance, more about establishing a correct mental model before users touched the product. Prototyped and validated multiple framing approaches against real activation data.
 - Designed interaction patterns that made LLM behavior predictable, helping users understand not just what agents do, but where they'll succeed and where they'll won't. Honest constraint communication as a trust-building mechanism.
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Coinbase – Developer Platform

Senior Product Designer – Developer Tools (Contract) | 2025

Developer tooling for complex blockchain data queries fails at the same place most developer tools do: discoverability under cognitive load. Developers know what they want; they can't find how to get it.

- Designed SQL-based query interfaces grounded in developer interviews and task analysis, optimizing specifically for error prevention and recovery, not just aesthetics. API constraints shaped design decisions from the start, not after handoff.
 - Contributed to Pay with USDC surfaces where clarity in financial interactions isn't a nice-to-have; errors in payment UX are costly and trust-destroying. Designed with that asymmetry in mind.
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CurbCutOS

Product Design Lead – SaaS Accessibility | 2023 – 2024

Accessibility compliance at enterprise scale was a manual, unscalable process: teams audited by hand, shipped blind, and discovered failures too late. The problem wasn't knowledge; it was infrastructure.

- Led the product transition from consulting-led services to a scalable SaaS platform. The core design challenge: building interfaces where users understood what the system validated automatically and where human judgment was still required. Automation without clarity erodes trust.
 - Reduced manual audit time by 60% through integrated testing flows. The impact wasn't just efficiency; it fundamentally changed when compliance feedback entered the development cycle.
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Zalando SE (now Partner)

Senior Product Designer – Design Systems | 2021 – 2022

Multiple B2B marketplace verticals, no shared design language. The trade-off: a system flexible enough to serve diverse product needs without fragmenting into incoherence.

- Contributed to the first B2B design system at Zalando, building component libraries and standards that enabled cross-team consistency without sacrificing the flexibility partners actually needed.
 - Worked directly with engineering to ensure adoption, understanding that a design system no one uses solves nothing. Scalability meant both technical reusability and organizational fit.
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Independent / Studio Work (Selected)

Independent Product Designer | 2016 – Present

Led product and system design engagements for early-stage startups and embedded product teams. Delivered AI-native UX, design systems, and rapid prototypes across SaaS, developer tools, and crypto.

Selected clients: Obvious.ai, Revolut, Coinbase, Zalando, Travelnest, Frequency (Berachain), Graceview.ai, JazzX AI (Microsoft), CurbCutOS, Artscapy, Kerubin.

Skills & Expertise

AI-Native Product Design

Designing for probabilistic behavior and model uncertainty · Prototyping AI responses and edge cases as decision tools · Trust-building in autonomous systems · Interaction models for conversational and agent-based AI · Designing for model evolution and continuous learning · Responsible AI advocacy

Technical Fluency & Collaboration

Understanding how AI models behave and fail · Working with research and engineering on model constraints · React/Tailwind prototyping for AI interactions · API-aware design for LLM-powered systems · Cross-functional influence through reasoning and narrative

Tools & Craft

Figma (advanced prototyping, variants, tokens) · Interactive prototyping (ProtoPie, Framer, code) · React, Tailwind, Framer Motion · LLM tooling and prompt systems · AI development tools (Cursor, Claude Code)

Education

Apple Developer Academy – UX / UI Design, Naples, Italy

ILAS Design School – Diploma with Honors

References

Available upon request.

Former managers and partners include senior leaders from Walmart, Obvious.ai, Coinbase, Voiceflow, Theoriq, Zalando, and CurbCutOS.